



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Redeemer Classical Academy

School Website: <https://redeemerclassicalacademy.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Redeemer Classical Academy (RCA) in Murfreesboro, TN 37128 presents a robust classical Christian program that aligns strongly with central classical education principles. The school identifies itself as Christ-centered, classical, and collaborative with families, and explicitly foregrounds the grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, a consistent Great Books emphasis, Latin study, and senior rhetoric work (e.g., Senior Thesis). Weekly chapel services and a Christian formation intent underpin its religious and metaphysical orientation, while the Omnibus reading list and the described curriculum signal attention to liberal arts and Western canon. Taken together, RCA demonstrates a substantial classical core with several strong category-specific signals, though some pedagogical implementations could be made more explicit in public materials to move all categories solidly into the Classical zone.

- Overall classification by category:
 - Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL
 - Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL
 - Element 3 (Curriculum): CLASSICAL
 - Element 4 (Pedagogy): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 5 (Faculty): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 6 (Parents & Community): CLASSICAL
- Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

Key supporting materials from RCA include the mission and Distinctives describing Christ-centered, classical, and collaborative aims; explicit grammar–logic–rhetoric structure; Omnibus Great Books reading lists; Latin study; Rhetoric-focused coursework (e.g., Senior Thesis Night); and explicit partnership language with parents (co-teachers). The publicly visible materials also reference classical resources and formation-focused practices that align with the six elements. See sources including RCA's mission and distinctives, Omnibus Reading List, 6-12 Curriculum, Latin Club materials, and faculty pages, as well as the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) framework for keyword mapping.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- RCA states a Christ-centered, ecumenically diverse community with a weekly chapel service and a “mere Christianity” approach to theological truth. This directly anchors the school in a theological framework that informs disciplines (the Mistress Science) and liturgical life.
- The mission explicitly centers virtue and redemption for God’s glory, signaling transcendental aims and the formation of character. The “Distinctions” describe Christian identity, classical method (grammar–logic–rhetoric), and liturgical life as integrated practice.
- Great Books and classical formation practices are foregrounded in the school's materials, reinforcing a perception of universal truths pursued through a sacred and communal framework (liturgical life, chapel, worship).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators from the Six Essential Elements include truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; chapels; virtue; sacred tradition; and a sacramental worldview. RCA's public materials reflect Christ-centered learning, weekly chapel, and virtue formation, aligning well with these signals.
- The school materials show explicit use of the liturgical/communal frame (chapel, worship) and theology as governing disciplines. See "Distinctives" and weekly chapel references.
- From the classical lexicon, terms like virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder, sacred music, and call to formation align with Positive keywords; RCA materials strongly reflect several of these signals.

Why this rating

- RCA demonstrates a clear religious/metaphysical foundation through theology, liturgy, and virtue formation, with explicit chapel practices and a Christian formation aim. The presence of a theologically integrated curriculum and communal worship strongly supports CLASSICAL status in this category.

What would move the needle

- Make explicit any transcendental "truth–goodness–beauty" triad in mission statements or curriculum narratives, if applicable, to further anchor transcendental realism signals.
- Contextualize liturgical practices with public-facing descriptions that connect worship to broader curricular aims (e.g., how liturgy informs character formation across disciplines).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission centers virtue, formation, and the goal of developing learners who are leaders and agents of redemption, not merely job preparation. The focus is on virtue and human formation rather than utilitarian ends.
- The school frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, consistent with paideia and classical aims; canonical Great Books engagement signals pursuit of timeless truths rather than solely market-driven outcomes.
- The Great Books emphasis and collaborative ethos align with the classical aim of cultivation of the mind (truth, goodness, beauty) within a community formation context.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords from the Six Essentials include formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, great conversation, and the pursuit of the true, good, beautiful. RCA's language emphasizes formation and virtue; great books.
- No explicit negative signals (e.g., "workforce preparation" emphasis) appear in RCA public materials. The focus remains on formation and virtue.

Why this rating

- Public materials consistently foreground formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth and wisdom rather than purely instrumental outcomes, aligning with CLASSICAL status for this category.

What would move the needle

- Consider adding explicit statements about long-term aims such as human flourishing and telos in mission language, to reinforce the full scope of formation goals beyond virtue alone.
- Provide public narratives that connect "formation" to measurable outcomes in college readiness or humanities mastery, if desired, while retaining the primary formation emphasis.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

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- The school divides students into grammar, logic, and rhetoric stages, a hallmark of classical curriculum.
 - Omnibus Reading List featuring major Western canon works (Homer, Odyssey, Iliad, The Republic, Augustine, Augustine, The Divine Comedy, The City of God, The Federalist, etc.) demonstrates a focus on Great Books and the Great Conversation.
 - 6-12 Curriculum shows Saxon Math, Apologia Science, Latin (First/Second Form Latin; Latin for the New Millennium), The Art of Argument, and The Discovery of Deduction, aligning with grammar, logic, rhetoric and broad liberal arts study.
 - The Omnibus program uses Veritas Press Omnibus for Theology, History, and Literature, reinforcing a Great Books approach across disciplines.
 - Latin Club and TJCL participation demonstrate classical language study and classical culture engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords from the Six Essentials include grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; history; Latin; primary sources; classical canon; Western civilization. RCA publicly uses grammar–logic–rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, and argumentative/written-work structures (e.g., Senior Thesis).
- No overt negative signals in RCA's curriculum presentation; the emphasis remains on the classical triad and canon.

Why this rating

- The curriculum content lives squarely in the classical tradition: Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, and liberal-arts orientation across K–12, with explicit Latin study and rhetorical work. This strongly supports CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Expand explicit articulation of how “Great Books” discussions are conducted (e.g., examples of Socratic-style dialogues or seminars) to strengthen the Pedagogy category (Element 4) and signal a fuller incorporation of the classical pedagogy signals.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials emphasize the classical framework (grammar–logic–rhetoric) and rhetoric-oriented coursework (Senior Thesis Night), plus Omnibus and Latin offerings, indicating a strong rhetorical emphasis in upper grades.
- There is explicit mention of “lower school devotional practices” (Weekly Grammar School Devotions) and a range of field experiences (Travel pages), suggesting some restful, contemplative elements and memorable experiences.
- The presence of “Latin Club,” TJCL achievements, and the Senior Thesis track signals engagement with higher-order thinking and rhetorical performance.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive signals from the Six Essentials for Pedagogy include Socratic seminar, narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, and rhetoric exercises; restfulness and scholé; and seminars. RCA shows strong emphasis on grammar/logic/rhetoric and senior rhetoric work, but explicit Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars are not clearly described in public pages. This yields a mix of signals focusing on rhetoric and classical forms without a clear, explicit articulation of all Socratic/seminar pedagogies.
- Negative signals (as defined in the Six Essentials lexicon) such as an exclusive emphasis on experiential learning, project-based learning, or constructivist pedagogy are not present in RCA's public materials; however, the lack of explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy reduces the strength of the “Socratic/seminar” signal.

Why this rating

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- RCA demonstrates a robust classical framework (grammar–logic–rhetoric, Great Books, rhetoric-driven upper grades, Senior Thesis), but explicit public articulation of Socratic seminars and scholé-based pedagogy is not clearly documented. The combination yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy rather than fully CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Publicly articulate explicit Socratic/Seminars-based practices in upper grades (e.g., documented seminars, Paideia-style experiences, or explicit inquiry-based discussions) and clearly describe contemplative or scholé days in the lower/upper school schedules.
- Include language about memorization, narration, and chanting in lower grades, with examples drawn from current or planned lesson plans, to strengthen signaling of contemplative/restful practices.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school lists credentialed faculty (Head of School; Bible Instructor; Latin Instructor; Grade-level instructors) with college and advanced degrees, and faculty pages include portraits and bios. This signals qualified teachers who can model virtue and knowledge.
- The Distinctives emphasize collaboration between teachers and parents, and the roles of teachers as partners in the student formation process; this suggests a relational, mentoring stance rather than a purely transactional staff model.
- However, explicit language on the faculty as the “living curriculum,” or a formal faculty portrait of the ideal teacher/student, is not clearly explicit in the public pages. The language tends toward collaboration and qualifications rather than a fully articulated classical “model teachers and mentors” living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords from the Six Essentials include “living curriculum,” “model teachers,” “mentors,” “character formation,” “collegial culture,” and “portrait of a teacher.” RCA’s site demonstrates capable, credentialed faculty and a collaborative atmosphere, but does not consistently label the faculty with “living curriculum” language or a formal portrait of teacher archetypes. This yields partial alignment with Positive keywords.
- Negative keywords (e.g., “certification-driven jargon without classical context”) are not presented; RCA appears to emphasize classical formation and mentorship rather than a functionally transactional approach.

Why this rating

- RCA exhibits qualified faculty and a collaborative, mentorship-oriented approach, but public materials do not consistently frame the faculty as the “living curriculum” or provide a formalized classical teacher archetype. This results in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL for this category.

What would move the needle

- Add explicit language and examples showing faculty as “the living curriculum” with portraits of teacher ideals, mentorship practices, and ongoing training specifically framed in classical pedagogy.
- Publish a formal “teacher profile” document that codifies the characteristics and roles RCA expects from its classical educators (e.g., masters in classical education, seminars for faculty, and continuous professional development in classical pedagogy).

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

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- RCA frames itself as a collaborative effort with Teachers and Parents working together to educate and enrich student life; families are encouraged to participate in home virtues and habits being formed at school. This signals genuine partnership with parents as co-teachers.
 - The site also references parent formation through resources and literature (e.g., *The Lost Tools of Learning*, classical education resources) and encourages parent involvement via tours, admissions, and community events.
 - The school publicly invites open visits and emphasizes parent engagement in school life (speaking on field trips, events, and collaborative initiatives). This aligns with a strong parental/community orientation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords from the Six Essentials include partnership with parents, parent formation, reading groups, seminars, family liturgy alignment, open campus, and parent covenant. RCA's materials explicitly discuss parents as co-teachers, home formation, and collaborative life. These map strongly to Positive keywords.
- Negative signals: none evident in publicly available content; RCA appears to welcome parent involvement and community engagement rather than treating parents as customers.

Why this rating

- The school explicitly positions parents as collaborators and co-teachers, and provides opportunities for parent formation and open campus visits, which aligns with CLASSICAL signaling in this category.

What would move the needle

- Expand formal parent-program offerings (e.g., regular classical book clubs, parent study guides aligned to the Great Books program) and publish a clear parent-education pathway to strengthen signaling of the “parents as co-teachers” principle.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): Publicly document and systematize Socratic/Paideia-style seminars in upper grades; include concrete examples in course syllabi and annual reports; integrate scholé/restful learning days into the master schedule and describe them publicly.
- Faculty (Element 5): Develop and publish a formal “living curriculum” portrait for faculty, with explicit language about teacher as mentor and exemplar; provide ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy and a visible faculty formation path.
- Parents & Community (Element 6): Build and publish a formal parent-formation program (book studies, seminars, and guided discussions tied to classical education) and expand visible opportunities for parent involvement beyond tours and events.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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